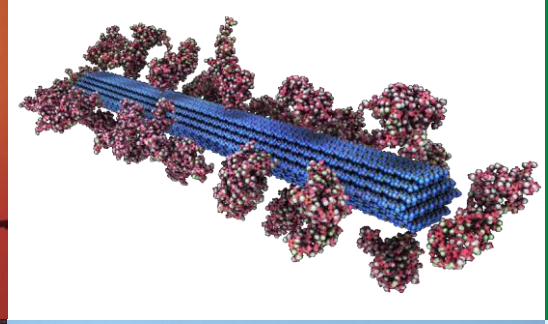

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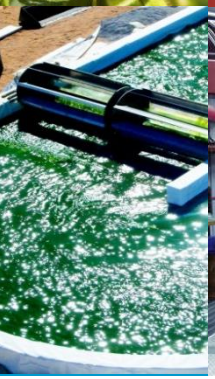

FY 2014 Strategic Communications Meeting

May 1, 2014

BETO Communications Team

Agenda

- FY 2014 Strategic Communication Goals: *12:00 p.m.–1:00 p.m.*
- Long-Term Communication Goals: *1:00 p.m.–2:00 p.m.*
- Media Analysis & Communications Research Project: *2:00 p.m.–2:45 p.m.*
- Meeting Wrap Up: *2:45 p.m.–3:00 p.m.*

FY 2014 Goals

BETO FY 2014 Strategic Communications Operating Plan Goals

- The FY 2014 Strategic Communications Operating Plan lays out annual goals for us to meet.
- We are going to review our progress toward each goal so far this fiscal year:
  - What goals are we on track to meet? What goals are we not on track to meet?
    - What actions can we take for the remainder of the fiscal year to help ensure that we meet all of our goals?

FY 2014 Goals Progress—Traditional Media

Traditional Media		
Communications Method	**2014 Targets**	**2014 Actuals**
Publications	**Goal:** Develop or update 15 publications	**Status: ON TRACK** Made major updates or developed 6 publications so far
Press Releases/Progress Alerts/News Items	**Goal:** Develop at least 25 progress alerts, press releases, or news items	**Status: ON TRACK** Developed 14 progress alerts, press releases, and news items to date
***EERE Media Clips**	**Goal:** Receive mentions in "EERE Media Clips" at least 4 times	**Status: ON TRACK/GOAL MET** A total of 187 biomass/bioenergy articles were included in the EE briefer emails
†Trade Publications	**Goal:** Track BETO efforts of submitting materials to trade publications	**Status: ON TRACK** BETO has been mentioned 2 times in Biofuels Digest to date

**** EERE discontinued the EE briefer emails in December 2013.***
† Goal added since beginning of the fiscal year.

FY 2014 Goals Progress—Website Content

Website Content		
Communications Method	**2013 Targets**	**2014 Actuals**
Office Website	**Total Visits:** Increase total visits by 3% (~130,816) **Total Visitors:** Increase unique visitors by 5% (~ 80,883) **Total Page Views:** Increase total page views by 2% (~322,426) **Pages Per Visit:** Increase pages per visit by 3% (~2.6) **Average Visit Time:** Increase average visit time by 3% (~3:04)	**Status: ON THE FENCE** **Total Visits:** 61,327 **Total Visitors:** 40,110 **Total Page Views:** 150,032 **Pages Per Visit:** 2.45 **Average Visit Time:** 3:02
Office Walkthrough	**Goal:** Update the presentation with new content prior to Biomass 2014	**Status: ON TRACK** Currently reviewing walkthrough content and determining necessary updates
FAQs	**Goal:** Complete work by end of Q1	**Status: COMPLETED** FAQs page went live at the beginning of Q3
Teacher/Student Educational Toolbox	**Goal:** Create/implement an educational tool box for the website	**Status: GOAL ADJUSTED** This effort is now an EERE-wide initiative
Widgets/Animations	**Goal:** Develop, debut, and promote at least 1 new widget/animation for the website	**Status: ON TRACK** Field-to-fuel animation is being developed
Accomplishments Web page	**Goal:** Update page at least 2 times annually **Goal:** Develop video for home page summarizing accomplishments; update twice annually	**Status: ON TRACK** Web page was updated in December 2013; will be updated again with revised 2-pager before *Biomass 2014* **Status: NOT ON TRACK** Draft video script was developed

FY 2014 Goals Progress—New and Digital Media

New and Digital Media		
Communications Method	**2014 Targets**	**2014 Actuals**
Blogs	**Goal:** 1 blog post per month on the BETO blog; 1 blog post per month on the EERE blog; and 1 blog post per quarter on Energy.gov	**Status: ON TRACK, except for the DOE-level goal** 8 total BETO blog posts; 7 EERE blog posts; and 1 Energy.gov blog post to date
GovDelivery Blasts	**Goal:** Send at least 24 blasts **Subscription:** Gain 2,000 new subscribers; maintain existing subscribers **Readership:** Increase average readership percentage to 19%	**Goal Status: ON TRACK** Sent 13 blasts to date **Subscription Status: ON TRACK** Gained 1,065 subscribers to date **Readership Status: ON THE FENCE** Average readership is 18% to date
Social Media	**Goal:** Post a minimum of 2 Facebook posts and 2 Tweets per month; engage in live tweeting/Facebook campaigns at Biomass 2014	**Status: ON TRACK** More than 70 social media posts, including KDF Facebook, Twitter, and LinkedIn, as well as DOE and EERE accounts
Multimedia	**Video Goal:** Develop, finalize, and post at least 12 videos (including 101 videos, staff spotlight videos, and biomass conference videos) **Infographic Goal:** Develop, finalize, and post at least 2 infographics	**Status: NOT ON TRACK** Posted 3 videos, including 1 staff spotlight video **Status: ON TRACK** 1 infographic was developed and finalized in October

FY 2014 Goals Progress—Conferences and Events

Conferences and Events		
Communications Method	**2014 Targets**	**2014 Actuals**
Biomass Conference	**Goal:** Increase registration and in-person attendance by 20% (registration: 600; attendance: 522)	**Status:** N/A—*Biomass 2014* will occur in July
Flash Drives	**Goal:** Order new flash drives and continue distributing the resources at conferences and events, cutting down on paper handouts	**Status: ON TRACK** Flash drives have been ordered and distributed at all conferences where BETO has had a presence
Presentations	**Goal:** Post all staff presentations to the BETO website within 1 to 2 weeks	**Status: ON TRACK** Posted all staff presentations to the Past Meetings Web page within 2 weeks except for the Bio-Oil Co-Processing Workshop presentations due to the site freeze
Booths and Exhibits, Partner and Industry Events	**Goal:** Revisit and implement the strategy Lindsay developed for sending the booth to events **Exhibits:** Continue to incorporate more interactive exhibits, if possible **Booth:** Continue to send lab staff to events when travel funds are unavailable	**Goal Status: ON TRACK** The BETO booth has been to 6 events and is planned to exhibit at 5 more; Lindsay's strategy will be revisited in June **Status Exhibits: NOT ON TRACK** There have been no interactive exhibits at the BETO booth at other industry events **Status Booth: ON TRACK** Funds have been available for BETO staff to attend each industry event this fiscal year
Webinars	**Goal:** Host 6 webinars	**Status: ON TRACK** 4 webinars have been hosted so far

FY 2014 Goals Progress—Internal Communications

Internal Communications		
Communications Method	**2014 Targets**	**2014 Actuals**
Success Stories	**Goal:** Submit 5 success stories per quarter	**Status:** ON TRACK Submitted 5 success stories in Q1 and Q2; 3 were posted by EERE and 2 are still in the process of being approved by EERE
Staff Profiles	**Goal:** Complete 12 staff profiles; present completed staff profiles at quarterly BETO meetings	**Status:** NOT ON TRACK 2 staff profiles have been completed; 1 staff profile is currently in progress
Web Brainstorming Meetings	**Goal:** Hold 2 Web brainstorming sessions annually	**Status:** ON TRACK The first Web Brainstorming Meeting was held on January 23
Strategic Planning Brainstorming Meetings	**Goal:** Hold 2 strategic planning meetings annually	**Status:** ON TRACK This is the second Strategic Communications Meeting of the fiscal year
Technology Area Meetings	**Goal:** Meet with technology area leads 2 times annually to discuss upcoming priorities, missions, goals, events, etc.	**Status:** ON TRACK Each technology area lead attended 1 weekly BETO Communications Team Meeting so far

FY 2014 Goals

EERE and BETO FY 2014 Strategic Communication Dashboard Goals

- The EERE and BETO FY 2014 Dashboards lay out strategic communication goals for us to meet this fiscal year, by quarter.
  - The EERE Dashboard includes goals directly from the BETO Dashboard.
- We are going to review our progress toward each goal so far this fiscal year:
  - Green indicates that we have achieved the metric (it has already happened).
  - Yellow indicates that we are on track to achieve it (we are planning it/working toward it, but it hasn't occurred/been completed yet).
  - Red indicates that we are not on track to meet that metric.
  - Gray indicates unknown items that require additional discussion today.
  - N/A indicates that a metric does not apply to a specific quarter.

FY 2014 Goals—BETO and EERE Dashboards

BETO Metric	Status			
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Have at least 1 BETO success story accepted for online publication outside of BETO.				
Host at least 1 webinar per quarter focused on major BETO projects and focuses.				
Release 3 monthly news blasts each quarter, promoting success stories, lab accomplishments, staff videos, upcoming events, and other key BETO highlights.				
Post 3 blog posts per quarter on the BETO blog.				
Post 1 blog post per quarter on Energy.gov.				

FY 2014 Goals—BETO and EERE Dashboards

BETO Metric	Status			
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Develop, debut, and promote at least one new animation for the BETO website.	N/A		N/A	N/A
Create at least two "BETO Staff" videos, as part of a series linking bioenergy FAQs with staff responses through videos on YouTube.	N/A			
DAS, Tech Offices, OSP – Work with OSP to Develop Tech Office "FY14 Tech Office Strategic Comms Plan:" In early Q2, identify highest-value media and stakeholder engagement for the year and set major targets/goals on strategies and tactics – e.g., announcements, promising innovations, major milestones, and successes associated with engagements. Agree upon external engagement plan (overlays and integrates already planned activities) and begin executing Feb. 1 (All Offices w/OSP).	N/A	X	N/A	N/A

FY 2014 Goals—BETO and EERE Dashboards

BETO Metric	Status			
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Update and post Accomplishments 2-pager outlining BETO accomplishments from the year.	N/A	N/A	N/A	
Update BETO Office Walkthrough interactive presentation and post online prior to *Biomass 2014* conference.	N/A	N/A	N/A	
Conduct *Biomass 2014* conference in Washington, D.C. (BETO's major annual conference).	N/A	N/A	N/A	
Create/implement an Educational Toolbox for the BETO website.	N/A	N/A	N/A	
Reassess and update "FY14 Tech Office Strategic Comms Plan" with OSP (All Offices w/OSP).	N/A	N/A	N/A	
Technology Offices: Work with OSP, in particular with Communications, on end of FY14 synthesis memo regarding cross-EERE tracking/analytics of announcements, milestones, successes, and engagements (All Offices w/OSP).	N/A	N/A	N/A	

Long-Term Communication Goals

- BETO Communications Team members were asked to complete a homework assignment prior to this meeting, providing inputs/ideas for some long-term communication goals we should consider pursuing in FY 2015.
- The results of this homework assignment will initiate our discussion today.
- As we go over the suggestions, some questions to think about include:
  - Do I agree with these goals? Do they support our mission?
  - Are these goals feasible/achievable?
  - Are we already carrying out activities in support of these goals?

Long-Term Communication Goals

Traditional Media

- *Trade Publications:*
  - Identify at least 1 opportunity per quarter to promote BETO news, events, and director appearances in trade publications

Website Content

- *BETO Web Pages:*
  - Include at least 1 graphic, animation, or widget on each BETO Web page
- *BETO Key Publications:*
  - Find an interactive way to feature BETO's key publications—perhaps an interactive flip book

BiofuelsDigest

The world's most widely read biofuels daily

BETO debuts interactive integrated biorefineries map

Isabel Lane | March 31, 2014

In Washington, the Bioenergy Technologies Office (BETO) has debuted an updated Integrated Biorefineries (IBR) Map, which displays the locations of BETO-supported IBRs and illustrates U.S. Department of Energy (DOE) investments in states across the country. The map's new interactive features reveal additional information about each state's IBR projects by identifying the types of technology used and the products manufactured at these facilities. This map will help users expand their understanding of IBRs as it applies to the potential for facilities to produce valuable materials that can be used in American-made products.

More on the story.

Print

Key Publications

This page contains a table that organizes the names and publication dates of the Bioenergy Technologies Office's key research and development portfolio documents, providing succinct descriptions of each document, and sorting them by category: fact sheets and summaries; design reports/case studies; and plans, roadmaps, and reports. Scroll through the table and read the descriptions to find the publication that best fits your needs.

Publication Name	Description	Date of Publication
FACT SHEETS AND SUMMARIES		
Office Overviews and Investments Summaries The Bioenergy Technologies Office works with industry, academia, and our national laboratory partners on a balanced portfolio of research in biomass feedstocks and conversion technologies. Through research, development, and demonstration efforts geared toward the deployment of first-of-a-kind integrated biorefineries, the Office is helping transform the nation's renewable and abundant biomass resources into cost competitive, high performance biofuels, bioproducts, and biopower.		
Reshaping American Energy - A Look Back at BETO's Accomplishments in 2013	This publication highlights a few significant accomplishments that the Bioenergy Technology Office (BETO) achieved in 2013. These accomplishments lead toward establishing a fully commercialized, robust, domestically sourced bioindustry. These efforts cover the full range of technology areas in BETO's portfolio.	November 2013
Replacing the Whole Barrel To Reduce U.S. Dependence on Oil	This overview provides highlights of the DOE Bioenergy Technologies Office's major research, development, demonstration, and deployment activities to advance biomass conversion, technology integration in biorefineries, and supply logistics to provide a secure, sustainable supply of advanced biofuels.	May 2013
Bioenergy Office Walkthrough	This interactive, overview presentation provides a full description of the Office's activities and future directions. It also contains brief videos about the Office.	June 2013

Long-Term Communication Goals

New and Digital Media

- *Multimedia:*
  - Create 1 infographic per quarter (*current goal is 2 per year)*
- *Social Media:*
  - Create more strategic/impact-oriented social media metrics—for instance, change metrics from 'post X number of updates per month' to 'gain X new followers/likes/shares/retweets/etc. annually'
  - Perform more fun social media contests—for instance, a "tweet-a-thon," a photo submission contest, or an 'ask a bioenergy expert' session

Conferences and Events

- *Flash Drives:*
  - Continue to use flash drives as a means of cutting down on paper handouts; however, identify other items BETO can distribute

Long-Term Communication Goals

Conferences and Events Cont'd

- *Booths and Exhibits:*
  - Revisit/implement Lindsay's strategy for sending the BETO booth to events
  - Publicize DOE participation at events before they occur
  - Continue to take photographs of BETO participation at events and publicize during and after through various outlets

Internal Communications

- *Review/Approval Processes:*
  - Perfect the approval process for social media deliverables so that posts are more timely
- *Outreach Process:*
  - Streamline the communications outreach process so that news items, social media posts, and other communications deliverables are released together in a timely manner

Long-Term Communication Goals

Strategic Planning / Messaging

- *National 'Misinformation' Campaign:*
  - Develop and implement a plan for debunking myths/misinformation and public misconceptions about ethanol and advanced biofuels.
    Potential components of the plan:
    - Incorporate our existing communications activities with new ones
    - Include outreach to partners to find out their biggest concerns regarding public perceptions
    - Explore the potential to share messaging with allied agencies (USDA, EPA) or organizations
    - Develop a schedule that includes timed releases, spokespersons, events, PSAs, etc.
    - Develop metrics to measure our progress

Long-Term Communication Goals

Strategic Planning / Messaging

- *Strategic Messaging/Audience Analysis Exercise:*
  - Incorporate the results from the Strategic Messaging/Audience Analysis exercise (from our January Strategic Messaging/Web Brainstorming Meeting) into our communication strategy/products. This would include—but is not limited to—the following actions:
    - Taking an inventory of the Office's communications products
    - Mapping products to our various target audiences (e.g., what products are used to communicate with which stakeholders)
    - Updating and/or developing new products (as needed) with targeted messaging

Long-Term Communication Goals

Next Steps

- What is our process for integrating these long-term goals into our communications strategy/plans?
  - Include them in the BETO FY 2015 Strategic Communications Operating Plan
  - Assign “Leads” who are responsible for activities in support of each new goal
- Are there any immediate action items or follow-up discussions that need to take place?

Media Analysis & Communications Research Project

Project Overview

- At the request of BETO, BCS initiated a two-part communications research project in November 2013 :
  - **Part I—Literature Review**: BCS performed a review of recent literature on public opinion and biofuel communication tactics to determine what work has been published in scholarly articles relating to how to best communicate biofuels.
  - **Part II—Media Analysis Research**: BCS analyzed media coverage of biofuels/ethanol over a 10-year time frame (2004–2014) to better understand trends in media coverage, potential impacts on public opinion, the shifting focus of media coverage, and the various frames through which the media cover the biofuels industry.

Media Analysis & Communications Research Project

Project Results

- The results of the analyses were summarized in reports and presentations, which included suggestions for how BETO can use the findings to enhance its communications strategy, be more strategic, and better promote the merits of advanced bioenergy.
- Today's discussion will focus on how the BETO Communications Team can incorporate the project findings into our efforts to better support the Office in achieving its mission.

Meeting Wrap Up

Next Steps and Action Items

- FY 2014 Goals
  - Have we identified the need to develop plans and/or implement any corrective actions to ensure that we meet all of our FY 2014 strategic communication goals?
    - If so, who are the assigned POCs?
- Long-Term Communication Goals
  - Did we determine any immediate actions that need to take place? Should we have a follow-up meeting to discuss integrating the long-term goals into our communication strategy?
- Media Analysis & Communications Research Project
  - Did we determine any follow-on actions for incorporating the results of the analyses into our communication efforts? Do we need to discuss this topic further?